

Group - 14 MoM – 1

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Stakeholder: Travellers, Explorers and Tourists who are looking for safe, secure exploration of places of tourist interest in India.

Problem Statement -

How might we empower solo travellers, especially women, to feel more secure by providing tailored safety solutions?

Scope of Review

- Focuses on how technology specifically mobile apps and digital platform addresses women's safety in public spaces.
- Draws on an extensive range of existing solutions to identify patterns, common features, and limitations.

Key Features Identified

- **SOS Alerts:** Rapid emergency call or text functionality to alert authorities and/or selected contacts.
- **Location Tracking:** GPS-enabled real-time tracking for sharing travel routes and current positions.
- **Community Reporting:** Crowdsourced incident alerts and safety ratings, helping users avoid unsafe areas or situations.

Why Women Feel Unsafe

1. Crowded Environments

- **Physical Proximity and Unwanted Contact:** In packed buses, trains, or streets, the lack of personal space can lead to heightened vulnerability, fear of harassment and difficulty escaping a threatening situation.

2. Dark Environments

- **Limited Visibility:** Darkness makes it harder to identify threats and read people's behavior. Potential attackers can also use low visibility to their advantage.
- **Psychological Impact:** Darkness often triggers heightened alertness or fear due to ingrained associations with danger and uncertainty.

3. Empty or Desolate Areas

- **Isolation:** Fewer people nearby means reduced likelihood of getting help in an emergency. Women may feel exposed if an assailant knows there are no witnesses.
- **Increased Anxiety:** A lack of human presence can intensify feelings of vulnerability, particularly in areas without security measures, cameras, or well-lit paths.

Questions of the Concept of Fear Defined by Women

Subjective Experience of Fear

- **Personal History:** Past experiences of harassment or assault (direct or indirect) often shape a woman's perception of what is "safe" or "unsafe."

Role of Environment and Context

- **Location Familiarity:** A well-known and frequently traversed environment can reduce fear, while new or foreign territories increase uncertainty.
- **Time of Day:** Even in the same geographical location, the atmosphere and risk perception change drastically depending on whether it's daylight or nighttime.

Insights of women while travelling

- **User-Centric Features:** Incorporate adjustable safety measures for different times of day (e.g., automatic "night mode" alerts that prompt extra caution or set up auto location-sharing after dark).
- **Environmental Context:** Use real-time data on crowd levels or public transport availability to suggest safer routes.
- **Personalized Recommendations:** Let women input their comfort levels so the system can tailor alerts or route suggestions based on their own risk perception.